

## BEFORE

The Late Bronze Age << 43 began with the rise of several new powers.

### THE HITTITES

The Hittite Old Kingdom formed in **Anatolia** (modern Turkey) in the 17th century BCE, but declined due to infighting. The New Kingdom emerged in the 15th century and expanded to challenge first **Mittani** (see below) and then **Egypt**. The state was divided into multiple kingdoms, each with a governor appointed by the great king, who ruled from the capital, **Hattusa**.



OLD-HITTITE  
GODDESS

### KASSITE BABYLONIA

In 1595 BCE the **Hittite king Mursili II** sacked Babylon, ending the **Old Babylonian period << 55**. Babylonia then rose slowly as a power under the **Kassites**—an Indo-Iranian group that had immigrated centuries before. The Kassites were known for *kudurru* (“boundary stone”) sculptures, which commemorated land grants.



KASSITE  
KUDURRU

### MYCENAE

The civilization that **dominated Greece** in the Late Bronze Age (1600–1100 BCE), Mycenae << 77 controlled much of the **Aegean Sea** and absorbed the **Minoan civilization << 76–77**.

### MITTANI

The kingdom of Mittani, populated by the **Hurrian people**, formed in **northwest Mesopotamia** in the 16th century BCE. Mittani **conquered Assyria 80–81 >>**, holding it as a dependent state until the 14th century, as well as fighting Egypt for control of southern Syria. The **Mittanian capital, Washshukanni**, has not yet been excavated or even precisely located.

### EGYPTIAN NEW KINGDOM

During its **New Kingdom << 64–65** (1550–1069 BCE), Egypt became the **world's leading power** and the major force in the Middle East. Expansionist policies created an empire that, in the 15th century BCE, stretched from modern-day **Lebanon to Sudan (ancient Nubia)**.



EGYPTIAN BRONZE AGE WAR CHARIOT

### Rameses III battles the Sea Peoples

Pharaoh Rameses III smites his enemies in his battles against the “Sea Peoples” during the 12th century BCE. Long blamed for the Bronze Age collapse, the Sea Peoples may have been opportunists attacking weakened states.

